# ALESSANDRO PIZZIGOLOTTO

**Department of Economics, University of Copenhagen**
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## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

**Postdoc, Department of Economics** September 2023 – present
University of Copenhagen
*Advisor* Jeanet Bentzen

## EDUCATION

**Ph.D. in Economics** 2018 – 2023
Norwegian School of Economics (NHH)
*Doctoral Thesis* *Essays on Political Empirical Economy and Household Behaviour*
*Examiners* Vincent Somville (NHH, chair), Gloria Gennaro (UCL), Matia Vannoni (KCL)
*Supervisors* Katrine V. Løken, Jósef Sigurdsson
*Research Visits* Stockholm University: October 2021 – July 2022
Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM): January 2022

**MSc. in Economics and Finance** 2014 – 2017
Università degli Studi di Padova, *with distinction*
*Exchange Student* University of Helsinki, MSocSc. in Economics
*Curriculum* Banking and Finance

**BSc. in Economics and Management** 2011 – 2014
Università degli Studi di Padova

**High School Diploma in Software Engineering** 2011
Istituto Tecnico Industriale Statale "F. Severi", 100/100

## TEACHING AND RESEARCH INTERESTS

*Primary*: Political Economy, Applied Microeconomics

*Secondary*: Household Finance, Economic History, Cultural Economics, Labour Economics

## REFERENCES

**Jeanet Sinding Bentzen, Associate Professor**
University of Copenhagen
Department of Economics
Øster Farimagsgade 5, building 26, office 26.2.26
jeanet.bentzen@econ.ku.dk (PI)

**Katrine V. Løken, Professor**
Norwegian School of Economics (NHH)
Department of Economics
Helleveien 30, 5045 Bergen, Norway
katrine.loken@nhh.no (Main Supervisor)

**Jósef Sigurdsson, Assistant Professor**
Stockholm University
Department of Economics
Universitetsvägen 10A, 114 18 Stockholm, Sweden
josef.sigurdsson@su.se (Supervisor)

**Jaakko Meriläinen, Assistant Professor**
Stockholm School of Economics
Department of Economics
Sveavägen 65, 11383 Stockholm, Sweden
jaakko.merilainen@hhs.se (Co-Author)

## SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

**Credit Shocks and Populism** with Nicolò Fraccaroli

We investigate whether credit shocks increase the electoral support for populist parties. We exploit the impact of an exogenous lending cut by a large German bank in 2007–08 on voting intentions using individual-level survey data. We implement a semi-supervised machine learning approach applied to the text of parliamentary speeches of each party to measure their degree of populist rhetoric. We find that exposure to the credit shock increases voters' support for parties that are populist, that adopt a populist rhetoric and that discuss more frequently bank-related topics. Analysing the shift in demand for populism activated by the shock, we validate an economic channel through which the credit shocks affects political preferences through the perceived decay of the local economy, expressed as discontent in the political market by voters. Decomposing the effect at individual level, we find that the labour market history of individuals is the most important factor in shaping the response in populist preferences, more than their current employment situation. Overall, we conclude that credit shocks are an important determinant of populism in the world.

**Learning from a Systemic Banking Crisis' Experience** with Nicolò Fraccaroli
*The Long-Run Impact on Borrowing Behaviour*

Does the experience of a banking crisis has an effect on households' portfolios? We investigate this question by focusing on households that migrated to Germany between 1950 and the 2007 financial crisis. Combining data on migrants from 123 different countries with data on systemic banking crises, we identify the impact of the crisis' experience through the variation in the timing of arrival. We compare households' portfolios of those with a household head that experienced a systemic banking crisis in her country of ancestry with those that did not. Focusing on loan portfolios, we find that household that witnessed at least a crisis earlier in their life are less likely to hold consumer loans than those that never experienced a crisis. Moreover, we show that the probability of borrowing is lower for migrants who experienced multiple crises compared to those that experienced a single episode, suggesting a cumulative effect of banking shocks. We propose analogous evidence on real estate portfolios. Overall, our results suggest that the cost financial crises is not limited to the short-term effects driven by losses in wealth and income, but rather a long-lasting effect due to households changing their behaviour.

**Volcanic Protests** with Jaakko Meriläinen, Matti Mitrunen and Jósef Sigurdsson

We investigate the historical origins of the French protest culture. Our study focuses on the societal consequences of the 1783 Laki volcanic eruption in Iceland, one of the largest volcanic events in recorded history. We document short- and medium-run impacts of the volcanic fallout on protests in France using estimates of regional sulfur concentrations in the atmosphere and information on riots and protests from the Ancien Régime till the French Revolution. Our results show that more particulate air pollution is associated with a higher prevalence of social conflict before and during the French Revolution, and also in the *longue dureé*.

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

**STR421 Competitive Strategy** Teaching Assistant, Spring 2023
*Norwegian School of Economics (NHH)* *Master's Level*

**ECN400 Macroeconomic Theory and Policy** Teaching Assistant, Fall 2020
*Norwegian School of Economics (NHH)* *Master's Level*

**ECN401 Applied Microeconomic Theory** Teaching Assistant, Spring 2020
*Norwegian School of Economics (NHH)* *Master's Level*

**ECN402 Econometrics** Teaching Assistant, Fall 2019 – Fall 2022
*Norwegian School of Economics (NHH)* *Master's Level*

**ECO433 Empirical Strategies for Causal Analysis** Teaching Assistant, Spring 2019
*Norwegian School of Economics (NHH)* *Master's Level*

## PRESENTATIONS AND CONFERENCES

**2024** ASREC Conference (Chapman University (Orange County, CA), attending the annual workshop).

**2023** Academic Job Market. Graduate Students in International Political Economy (GSIPE) Workshop (online). 5th Annual COMPTEXT Conference 2023 (University of Strathclyde, Glasgow). APSA Annual Meeting 2023 (Los Angeles, canceled).

**2022** Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM, Political Economy Group, Mexico City). University of Gothenburg. FAIR Midway Conference 2022 (Sommarøy, Norway, Poster Session). Norwegian School of Economics (Brownbag, CELE Coffee Meeting, Emerging Research Seminar)

**2021** Scandinavian PhD Seminar (online). EPSA Virtual Conference 2021 (*joint with co-author*). XXXII Villa Mondragone International Economic Seminar (*joint with co-author*, Rome Tor Vergata/online). 2nd Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Conference (online). IFABS 2021 Oxford Conference (Saïd Business School, Oxford/online). Stockholm University (SU Labor Fika, Microwave Seminar). Joint Bank of England, the European Central Bank, King's College London and King's Business School Conference on new methods and applications for macroeconomic policy (*joint with co-author*, London/online).

**2020** Norwegian School of Economics (Friday Lunch Seminar, Emerging Research Seminar). INET/Young Scholars Initiative: New Economic Questions (Political Economy of Europe Working Group (*joint with co-author*), Financial Stability Working Group, online).

## RELEVANT SKILLS

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|---|---|
| **Programming** | C/C++, Java, PHP (pre-graduate), Python (intermediate), R (advanced), MATLAB (basic), LaTeX |
| **Software** | STATA (advanced), Excel, mySQL (intermediate), QGIS (intermediate) |
| **Sysadmin** | Unix/Linux, Windows |
| **Language** | Italian (Native), English (Fluent), Norwegian and Danish (Survival Skills) |

## AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

**University Lecturer (50%)** October 2022 - August 2023
*Norwegian School of Economics (NHH), Department of Economics*

**Erasmus+ Scholarship for Training** Summer 2019
*European Commission*

**Ph.D. Research Scholar (Full-Stipend)** 2018 - 2022
*Norwegian School of Economics (NHH), Department of Economics*

**Erasmus+ Scholarship** 2015 - 2016
*European Commission*

## PAST APPOINTMENTS AND PROFESSIONAL EMPLOYMENT

**Graduate Research Assistant** July 2017 - July 2018
*European Central Bank* *Sonnemannstraße 20, 60314 Frankfurt am Main, Germany*

Research Assistant related to the Household Finance and Consumption Network (HFCN) at the Directorate General Research of the European Central Bank. Main Research Project: "Monetary Policy and Household Inequality" *Principal Investigators*: Oreste Tristani, Jiří Slačálek.

**Credit Analyst Assistant** June 2014 - August 2014
*Cassa Centrale Banca S.p.A.* *Via Segantini, 5, 38122 Trento, Italy*

**Web Developer, Software Developer and Webmaster** November 2011 - March 2013
*Bortolami Ricambi s.a.s.* *Via Marco Polo, 35020 Albignasego, Italy*

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